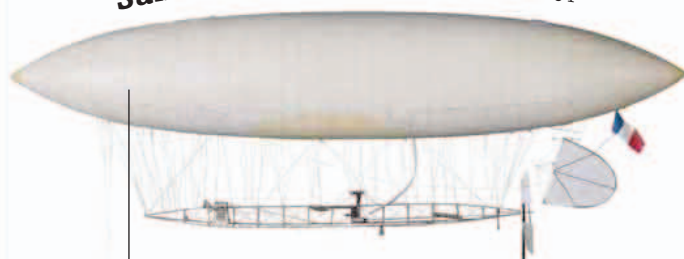




Air

Racers and record-breakers

Santos-Dumont No.6 France 1901



72-ft-1in- (22-m-) long envelope filled with hydrogen gas

Cabane struts hold wires that brace wings

Nieuport II N France 1910



Four-bladed propeller turned by Rolls Royce Eagle VIII engine

Wingspan of 68ft (20.7m)

SPAD Deperdussin Monocoque France 1913



Smooth, streamlined body made of wood

Solid disc wheels

Ryan NYP Spirit of St. Louis USA 1927



Large fuel tank holds 211 gal (800 liters) of fuel

Steel tube fuselage

Vickers Vimy UK 1918



Curtiss-Robin J-1 Ole Miss USA 1928



Getting into the air wasn't enough for some pilots and engineers. They wanted to push their planes to the limit and fly higher, faster, longer than others. Races were held, records set and broken, as aircraft became stronger, more powerful, and reliable.

In 1901, the **Santos-Dumont No.6** airship won one of the first aviation prizes—100,000 French francs in 1901 for a flight around the Eiffel Tower. In 1919, the **Vickers Vimy** made the first nonstop flight across the Atlantic. American aviator Charles Lindbergh completed a 33½ hour